From: Christopher A. Hanson
To: Board of Governors Office of Inspector General and Director of Compliance (Inspector General Julie Leftheris)
Date: October 27, 2026, 9:54 AM ET
Subject: Complaint against Florida State University, NEW COMPLAINT, but factually related to OIGC 2027-054 (University of Florida): request for investigation under Regulation 4.004(3)
(Email body as sent. The two attachments are not included in this copy.)

Inspector General Leftheris and the Office of Inspector General and Director of Compliance:

I am filing this complaint against Florida State University. It is related to OIGC 2027-054, my pending complaint against the University of Florida, and I ask that both be placed before Chancellor Rodrigues for a determination under Regulation 4.004(3) that they warrant an investigation under your Office's direction.

MY COMPLAINT AGAINST THE UNIVERSITY OF FLORIDA (OIGC 2027-054)

My complaint against the University of Florida alleges that UF is intentionally concealing records that fall clearly within the constitutional definition of public records, that it misrepresented those records to the Eighth Judicial Circuit in bad faith, and that it continues to cover up the internal misconduct behind that concealment. These records are critically important to the public. On May 4, 2026, UF wrote me, "This completes the public records request," while it held the 330 pages its own search had returned on March 30 for my March 26 request. My October 20 complaint also asked for an investigation of the Eighth Judicial Circuit's handling of my case against UF.

On October 26, your Office wrote that it would refer the complaint to UF's Chief Audit Executive. UF's charter has that officer report administratively to UF's President and its General Counsel, the office whose statements the complaint concerns. I replied that day and asked for a preliminary inquiry and a determination under Regulation 4.004(3). The court record is at https://tinyurl.com/toc-uf-docket.

Both complaints sit inside a larger pattern. There is a real question over severe and widespread misconduct at the core constitutional freedom. Are the media and the judiciary colluding to limit coverage of newsworthy events? So that insiders avoid accountability for their misconduct? I have been a member of The Florida Bar since 2007, AV-rated, with no history of discipline. I do not make these allegations lightly. These are public records these institutions are hiding. The Public has a right to know why.

FROM UF TO FSU

I requested assistance from Florida State University because the University of Florida's Brechner Freedom of Information Project refused to help me. Brechner says it is "committed to equipping people, through research and education, with the tools they need to acquire government records, identify threats to transparency ..." On March 19, 2026, its director, Dr. David Cuillier, wrote me: "it's not our mission to connect people to journalists ... (nor do we do public statements, amici, etc.)." He referred me to FSU's First Amendment Clinic: "their mission is to help people with these problems" (https://tinyurl.com/hanson-cuillier-3-19-26). On March 25 he confirmed in writing that Brechner would give me no help beyond referrals and no comment on my situation: "Yep, that is correct."

FSU's First Amendment Clinic says it "provides pro bono legal representation to individuals and organizations across the country whose rights to free speech, religious freedom, freedom of association and assembly, or freedom of the press are at risk" (https://law.fsu.edu/academics/clinical-programs/first-amendment-clinic). Here is what FSU did, from my first contact.

FSU, EVENT BY EVENT Date (2026) What happened March 25 I asked FSU's First Amendment Clinic to take my matter, "First Amendment Retaliation and the Right of Access to Judicial Records." April 9 The Clinic opened a file on my inquiry. Its supervising staff attorney, Sheena Kelly, saved a note in it: "Rumberger Kirk attorneys to contact: Jeffrey Grosholz Richard Greenberg." (Attachment item 5.) April 27 The Clinic turned me away (https://tinyurl.com/hanson-fsu-clinic-decline). The same day I asked whether it had "communicated with anyone other than myself" about my cases, and wrote that a records request would follow. Ms. Kelly forwarded my question to the Clinic's director, Professor Denise Harle, writing: "I do not plan on responding and do not think a response is necessary." (Item 3.) April 29 Professor Harle wrote to Dean Erin O'Hara O'Connor of the College of Law that I "would be submitting a public records request," and asked: "Should I loop in Carolyn or not at this point?" (FSU's Vice President for Legal Affairs and General Counsel is Carolyn A. Egan.) April 30 Dean O'Connor answered: "The request will go to GC and then be forwarded to us." GC is FSU's Office of the General Counsel. I had not yet filed any request. (Item 4.) July 4 I filed request #26-578 for the Clinic's records about me and my cases. FSU's portal answered, "We will begin a search for records soon." Apart from automated messages, FSU then sent nothing until August 25, the 52nd day. August 22 I served written notice under section 119.12(1)(b), Florida Statutes. August 25 Two business days later, FSU's Office of the General Counsel wrote that its search "returned 99 records that may be responsive," put the remaining work at 1.16 hours, and demanded a $33 check or money order, warning: "If we do not timely hear from you within 14 calendar days, this request will be closed." FSU held me to 14 days; it has held itself to none (see August 28). (Item 1.) August 28 I filed request #26-747 for FSU's own search and processing records on #26-578. In 60 days FSU has sent nothing on it but the portal's automated acknowledgment. (Item 6.) September 28 I mailed the $33 check. FSU confirmed receipt on October 5. October 8, 5:37 PM FSU released 422 pages and wrote, in an unsigned message, that "the University is not required to answer questions posed under Chapter 119," though section 119.07(1)(f) requires it to state its reasons in writing when asked, and I had asked four times. I asked a fifth time on October 11; FSU has not answered. The release identifies no file from the Dean's mailbox and no account of the 99 records. (Item 2.) October 8, 5:38 PM Twenty-six seconds later, FSU's portal closed #26-578 as "fulfilled." October 11 My letter and section 119.12(1)(b) notice to FSU's Office of the General Counsel (item 7). The same day I filed request #26-953, at FSU's own written invitation to "make another public records request." It has drawn only an automated acknowledgment, as has request #26-938, filed October 6. October 20 and 25 Emails to the Office of the General Counsel and Deans O'Connor and Kazmer (item 8). On October 25 I asked how a member of the public requests a formal investigation of FSU's handling. None has been answered.

A verified petition for writ of mandamus on all four FSU requests will be filed in Leon County as soon as possible, potentially even this week. The petition asks a court to compel production of the records. This complaint asks who at FSU made these decisions and why.

THE INVESTIGATION CAN BE SIMPLE

This need not be an expensive or sprawling investigation. One step likely settles both matters: have the records offices of the University of Florida and Florida State University produce to your Office, for inspection in camera if needed, every record their initial searches identified, in native form, with the metadata that shows each one is a record those searches found. UF's first search returned 330 pages on March 30. FSU's returned 99 records on August 25. If the universities produced what their searches found, the metadata will show it. If they did not, it will show that too. Their refusals to provide confirmation on the identity of the documents are telling.

WHAT I ASK, IN WRITING, BY 5:00 PM, Friday, October 30, 2026

The scope of this problem, its effect on constitutional rights, and the hypocrisy of it call for every form of review your Office can order or request. I ask your Office to:

1. Give this complaint a number, or join it to OIGC 2027-054, and tell me which.

2. Place this complaint and OIGC 2027-054 before Chancellor Rodrigues for a determination under Regulation 4.004(3), and tell me the date they go to him.

3. Obtain from both universities' records offices every record their initial searches identified on my requests, in native form with metadata, for your Office's inspection, and open a preliminary inquiry into both universities now.

4. If the Board finds that either board of trustees is unwilling or unable to address these allegations, investigate under section 20.155(5), Florida Statutes, whose Office exists to "detect fraud and abuse within state universities," using the subpoena power in paragraph (5)(b).

5. The record above gives your Office reasonable grounds to believe section 119.10(1)(b), Florida Statutes, has been violated: it makes a public officer's knowing violation of section 119.07(1) a first-degree misdemeanor. Section 20.055(7)(c) then requires a report to the Florida Department of Law Enforcement. I ask that you make it.

6. Route neither complaint to either university's Office of the General Counsel or to any officer who reports to it, including UF's Chief Audit Executive, and tell me in writing to whom any part is forwarded.

7. Ask both universities to preserve, in native form with all metadata, the records of my requests, and confirm to me in writing, with the date, that each has been directed to do so:

(a) the University of Florida: UF IT?s March 30, May 4 and May 7, 2026 search outputs for request W018463-032626, including the 330-page March 30 output, the 109-page May 4 rerun and the 88-page May 7 file; UF IT?s delivery emails and Dropbox folders for those searches; the records office?s U: drive folders for that request; the search records for request W019186-071326; the files University counsel sent to Judge Keim?s chambers on September 2, 2026; and the audit logs for each system, so that the date of any deletion or alteration can be determined; and

(b) Florida State University: the records of requests #26-578, #26-747, #26-938 and #26-953, including the search export ?26_578_search_3_export_3,? every hit list, the list of the 99 records, the Clinic?s Clio Grow matter file and audit log, and the email and Teams messages of the Clinic, the Dean, Professor Ryan Owens and the Office of the General Counsel about me or these requests.

8. Answer in writing my October 26 requests on OIGC 2027-054.

WHY IT MATTERS

Article I, section 24(a) of the Florida Constitution gives every person the right to inspect public records. Two public universities run programs built around open government and the First Amendment, and each denied that right to the citizen who came to that program for help. If there is even a chance that the leaders of the Brechner Freedom of Information Project, the individuals molding this future generation of journalists, are engaging in misconduct that is antithetical to the Project's stated mission, the public has a right to know. The same is true of a law-school clinic whose students, in its own words, are "at the center of this work."

Two attachments: the 20-page FSU record, which holds FSU's own letters and messages and mine to FSU, indexed on its first page; and my October 20 complaint against UF as sent, with the letter it carried. I will provide anything else your Office needs. I'm happy to provide a sworn statement and/or sit for a deposition.

Please consider the facts I present independently of the consequences they may require. This should not be a situation where the state is uniformly against the public interest although it's already reached the Universities in a truly terrifying way.

Respectfully,

Christopher A. Hanson, self-represented Fla. Bar No. 44094